



Vidyavardhini's College of Engineering & Technology

Department of Computer Engineering

Academic Year : 2024-25

Experiment No.9
Analyze competitor activities using social media data.
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Aim: Analyze competitor activities using social media data.

Objective: To Utilize Google Trends to track and analyze competitor activities on social media platforms, extracting insights on product visibility, user engagement, and market trends. Compare the performance metrics obtained from Google Trends to assess relative strengths and weaknesses among competitors, facilitating informed strategic decisions and competitive positioning.

Theory:

Social media competitor analysis refers to the process of evaluating and analyzing the social media strategies, techniques, and performance of competitors to gain insights and leverage them to your advantage. It involves examining their content, engagement metrics, audience demographics, ad campaigns, and overall online presence.

A social media competitor analysis is an *analysis* of your *competition* on *social media* to find out what their strengths and weaknesses are, and how those strengths and weaknesses compare to your own. It's a process of benchmarking your own results against the heavy-hitters in your industry, so you can identify opportunities for growth as well as strategies that aren't performing as well as they should.

A social media competitive analysis, specifically, will help you:

- Identify who your competitors are on social media
- Know which social media platforms they're on
- Know how they're using those platforms
- Understand how well their social and content strategies are working
- Benchmark your social results against the competition
- Identify social threats to your business
- Find gaps in your own social presence

What is Google Trends?

Google Trends is a website by Google that analyzes the popularity of top search queries in Google Search across various regions and languages. It uses graphs to compare the search volume of different queries over time. Essentially, Google Trends provides insights into what people are currently interested in and curious about by examining their search behavior. The data is anonymized, categorized, and aggregated, allowing measurement of interest in specific topics globally or at a city-level geography.

Implementation and Output:

Here are the steps to perform product comparison using Google Trends:



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- **Access Google Trends:**

To begin, visit the Google Trends website by navigating to <https://trends.google.com>. Google Trends is a free tool that allows users to explore search trends over time, providing valuable data on what people are searching for globally or within specific regions.

- **Enter Product Keywords:**

Next, in the search bar, type in the product or brand names you wish to analyze. For example, enter "Brand A", "Brand B", and "Brand C" to compare their relative performance. You can also use keywords related to their products (e.g., "smartphone", "laptop", etc.) if comparing products rather than brands.

- **Adjust Time Frame and Geography:**

After entering the keywords, set the time frame you want to analyze. For instance, you can select "Past 12 months" or a custom date range depending on the period you're interested in. Additionally, choose the geographical region you want to focus on (e.g., United States, Europe, or a specific city). Adjusting these parameters will allow you to see how the keywords have performed over time and in specific locations.

- **Refine Search Parameters (Optional):**

Google Trends offers options to refine your search further. You can select different categories (e.g., "Technology", "Business") or filter by search type (e.g., web search, image search, or news search). If you want to compare multiple terms, Google Trends allows you to enter up to five search terms at once for a direct comparison.

- **View Search Interest Over Time:**

Once you've entered the keywords, Google Trends will generate a graph showing the search interest over time. The graph will indicate periods where interest surged or dipped for each keyword. For example, you might see a spike in interest for "Brand A" during its product launch month or a dip in interest for "Brand C" after an unsuccessful marketing campaign.

- **Analyze Regional Interest:**

Google Trends also displays a map with a regional breakdown of interest, allowing you to identify where each product or brand is most popular. This can reveal which areas have the strongest user engagement. For example, if "Brand A" is more popular in California and "Brand B" sees stronger interest in Texas, this can indicate regional strengths for each brand.

- **Compare Search Terms:**

You can compare the search interest for up to five different terms simultaneously. This allows you to directly compare the popularity of different brands or products over the same period. For example, comparing "Brand A", "Brand B", and "Brand C" will provide insights into which competitor has the most consistent interest over time.

- **Export Data (Optional):**



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If you need to analyze the data further, you can export the information into a CSV file. This allows you to create custom charts, reports, or integrate the data into other analysis tools. Simply click the "Download" button to save the data to your computer.

- **Draw Insights and Make Decisions:**

After analyzing the search volume, regional interest, and trends over time, draw conclusions from the data. For instance, if you find that "Brand A" experiences peaks in interest during specific months, it may indicate successful marketing or product launches. If "Brand C" shows no significant search interest, it could point to a need for better engagement or marketing. These insights can inform strategic decisions on how to enhance your own product visibility and social media engagement.

Conclusion:

By utilizing Google Trends, businesses can effectively analyze competitors' social media activities and track important performance metrics. The tool allows for real-time insights into product visibility, regional interest, and user engagement, helping to identify key trends and opportunities. By comparing competitors' search performance, businesses can adjust their strategies to remain competitive, optimize marketing efforts, and position themselves more effectively within the market. Insights drawn from these trends can lead to informed decision-making and improved overall strategy in response to competitor movements.